

7-Day South Indian Eggetarian Meal Plan

A practical, protein-aware, fibre-rich weekly plan for a busy working professional

Profile	Daily protein target	Approach
Female, 30+ • 70 kg • 163 cm • Eggetarian • Medium spice	84–98 g/day ($\approx$ 1.2–1.4 g/kg/day)	Home-style Tamil Nadu foods • whole grains • legumes • eggs • curd • abundant vegetables & whole fruit

How to use this plan

- **Protein is distributed:** breakfast, lunch, snack and dinner each contribute meaningful protein rather than relying on one food.
- **Fibre is built in:** dals, legumes, vegetables, whole grains/millet, seeds/nuts and whole fruit appear throughout the week.
- **Carbohydrates are practical:** cooked portions are stated so rice, millet, dosa, idli and other staples can fit comfortably into a working day.
- **Dinner stays lighter:** generally smaller grain portions with dal/legumes, vegetables, curd, egg or tofu/paneer.
- **No crash-diet approach:** portions are starting points. If genuinely hungry, add a sensible portion of vegetables, curd, dal/legume or another whole-food protein.

Portion conventions

Rice/millet quantities are **cooked** unless explicitly marked raw. Dal/legume amounts in recipes are raw when stated; otherwise the cup measure refers to the prepared food. Fruit means whole fruit, not juice. Protein values are approximate and depend on recipe, brand and portion size.

South Indian style: medium spice, home-style tempering, sambar/rasam/poriyal/kootu, curd-based sides and commonly available Tamil Nadu ingredients.

Monday–Thursday

Use the meal descriptions as a flexible framework; meals can be shifted by 30–60 minutes around work meetings and commute.

Breakfast	Mid-Morning	Lunch	Evening Snack	Dinner	Vegetables	Fruits	
2 pesarattu (from ~70 g raw whole green gram) + 2 boiled eggs + 150 g curd + tomato-onion chutney. Add ½ cup grated carrot-cucumber kosambari.	1 medium guava + 1 small orange.	Traditional meal: 1 cup cooked red rice; sambar with drumstick, carrot, pumpkin & brinjal; ¾ cup beans poriyal; ¾ cup cabbage-carrot poriyal; rasam; 150 g curd.	1 cup black-chana sundal + 1 small apple.	2 small ragi dosas + 1 cup moong-dal vegetable soup + 1 boiled egg + cucumber-tomato salad.	Drumstick, carrot, pumpkin, brinjal, beans, cabbage, cucumber, tomato	Guava, orange, apple	≈900 kcal
Vegetable oats upma: 1½ cups cooked oats with peas, carrot, beans & capsicum + 2 eggs bhurji + 150 g curd.	1 medium papaya bowl (~1 cup) + 1 small mosambi.	One-pot: 1½ cups cooked foxtail-millet vegetable egg rice with peas, carrot, beans, capsicum + 2 eggs + ¾ cup cucumber-carrot raita.	1 cup steamed green-gram sundal + 10 almonds + 1 small banana.	2 small vegetable uthappams + 1 cup sambar (toor dal, bottle gourd, tomato, onion) + 100 g curd.	Peas, carrot, beans, capsicum, cucumber, bottle gourd, tomato, onion	Papaya, mosambi, banana	≈800 kcal
3 small idlis + 1 cup sambar + 2 boiled eggs + 150 g Greek yogurt/strained curd + mint-coriander chutney.	1 medium apple + 1 cup papaya.	Traditional meal: 1 cup cooked brown rice; sambar with ladies' finger, pumpkin, carrot & brinjal; ¾ cup beetroot poriyal; ¾ cup snake-gourd kootu; rasam; 150 g curd.	¾ cup roasted chana + 1 small guava.	2 small pesarattu + 1 cup vegetable moong soup + 100 g tofu pepper fry + tomato-cucumber salad.	Ladies' finger, pumpkin, carrot, brinjal, beetroot, snake gourd, tomato, cucumber	Apple, papaya, guava	≈900 kcal
2 small adai (from ~75 g raw mixed dal) + 1 boiled egg + 150 g curd + cabbage-carrot stir-fry (~½ cup).	1 medium orange + 1 cup watermelon.	One-pot: 1½ cups cooked little-millet mixed-dal rice with moong/toor dal, spinach, carrot, beans & peas + 2 boiled eggs + cucumber-onion raita.	1 cup corn chaat with tomato, cucumber & coriander + 150 g curd + 1 small apple.	2 small millet dosas + 1 cup tomato-lentil soup + 100 g paneer and capsicum stir-fry.	Cabbage, carrot, spinach, beans, peas, cucumber, onion, tomato, capsicum	Orange, watermelon, apple	≈900 kcal

Friday–Sunday

Breakfast	Mid-Morning	Lunch	Evening Snack	Dinner	Vegetables	Fruits
2 small vegetable dosas + 2-egg vegetable scramble + 150 g curd + ½ cup sautéed spinach & tomato.	1 medium guava + 1 small banana.	Traditional meal: 1 cup cooked hand-pounded rice; sambar with ash gourd, carrot, drumstick & tomato; ¾ cup cluster-beans poriyal; ¾ cup keerai poriyal; rasam; 150 g curd.	1 cup white-chana sundal + 1 small pomegranate bowl (~¾ cup arils).	2 small idlis + 1 cup moong-dal sambar + 1 boiled egg + cucumber-carrot salad + 100 g curd.	Spinach, tomato, ash gourd, carrot, drumstick, cluster beans, greens, cucumber	Guava, banana, pomegranate
2 small ragi vegetable uthappams + 2 eggs (boiled/poached) + 150 g curd + tomato chutney.	1 medium apple + 1 cup papaya.	One-pot: 1½ cups cooked vegetable egg biryani using basmati/seeraga samba rice + 2 eggs + peas, carrot, beans, cauliflower & capsicum + ¾ cup onion-cucumber raita.	1 cup sprouted green-gram chaat + 10 peanuts + 1 small orange.	1½ cups light vegetable khichdi with moong dal, bottle gourd, carrot & spinach + 100 g tofu + cucumber-tomato salad.	Tomato, peas, carrot, beans, cauliflower, capsicum, onion, cucumber, bottle gourd, spinach	Apple, papaya, orange
2 small dosa + 1 cup sambar + 2-egg omelette with onion, tomato & spinach + 150 g curd.	1 medium mosambi + 1 cup watermelon.	Traditional meal: 1 cup cooked foxtail millet; sambar with brinjal, drumstick, carrot & pumpkin; ¾ cup beans poriyal; ¾ cup cabbage-peas poriyal; rasam; 150 g curd.	1 cup roasted kala-chana + 1 small banana + 10 almonds.	2 small adai + 1 cup vegetable dal soup + 100 g paneer/tofu pepper-capsicum bowl + cucumber salad.	Onion, tomato, spinach, brinjal, drumstick, carrot, pumpkin, beans, cabbage, peas, capsicum, cucumber	Mosambi, watermelon, banana

Workday tip: If lunch is delayed, use the planned snack rather than arriving at dinner extremely hungry. Keep water accessible and eat away from the keyboard when possible.

Weekly Nutrition & Quality Summary

Check	Result
Protein	All seven days are planned around ≈88–95 g/day, within the requested 84–98 g/day range. Protein is distributed across breakfast, lunch, snack and dinner.
Vegetable variety	Every day lists 8+ vegetable ingredients in the plan's vegetable column. Sambar vegetables are explicitly named and are separate from the two additional vegetable sides on traditional-meal days.
Whole fruit	Each day includes 3 whole-fruit kinds/servings, rotated across guava, papaya, banana, orange/mosambi, apple, pomegranate and watermelon.
Fibre	Daily fibre sources include whole green gram, chana, roasted legumes, mixed dals, millets/whole grains, vegetables, fruit, nuts and seeds/legume-based snacks.
Carbohydrate balance	Cooked rice/millet portions are generally ~1–1½ cups at lunch, with lighter grain portions at dinner. Idli/dosa/adai portions are paired with dal, eggs, curd, tofu or paneer and vegetables.
Protein-source variety	Green gram, mixed dals, black/white/kala chana, sprouts, eggs, curd/Greek yogurt, tofu and occasional paneer are rotated rather than relying on one source.
Practicality	Most meals can be batch-prepped: sambar/dal, cooked grains, boiled eggs, soaked/pressure-cooked legumes, chopped vegetables, batter and curd can cover several workdays.

Simple substitution guide

- **Rice:** red rice ↔ hand-pounded rice ↔ brown rice ↔ foxtail/little millet, keeping cooked portions similar.
- **Legumes:** black chana ↔ white chana ↔ kala chana ↔ green gram ↔ sprouts.
- **Curd:** regular curd ↔ Greek yogurt/strained curd; choose unsweetened versions.
- **Eggs:** boiled ↔ omelette ↔ bhurji; keep vegetables generous.
- **Fruit:** swap within the seasonal whole-fruit list while retaining roughly 3 servings/kinds across the day.

Weekly Meal-Prep Guide

Task	Practical approach
Batch sambar/dal	Cook a large pot 2 times/week. Keep the base moderately spiced and add/rotate vegetables so it stays interesting.
Pressure-cook legumes	Prepare chana, green gram and other legumes in batches; cool promptly and refrigerate in meal-sized portions.
Prepare sundal portions	Portion ~1 cup cooked legumes into containers. Temper lightly with mustard, curry leaves, chilli and grated coconut if desired.
Boil eggs	Prepare several eggs ahead for breakfast, snacks or dinner; refrigerate and use within safe storage limits.
Wash/chop vegetables	Prep hardy vegetables and salad ingredients in batches. Keep leafy greens separate and dry.
Batter	Make/refresh idli, dosa, adai or pesarattu batter for 2–3 workdays; freeze or refrigerate portions as appropriate.
Cook grains	Batch-cook red rice, hand-pounded rice or millet. Portion into containers so weekday lunches need minimal assembly.
Fruit portions	Wash ready-to-eat fruit; portion papaya/watermelon/pomegranate and keep whole fruits visible for easy access.
Curd/yogurt	Keep plain curd or unsweetened Greek yogurt ready for breakfast, lunch raita and snacks.
Quick backup meals	Keep cooked dal + frozen/chopped vegetables + eggs/tofu + a cooked grain available. A quick dal-rice bowl or egg vegetable rice is better than skipping a meal.

Mindful Eating Reminders

- Eat slowly and pause midway through meals.
- Start with the planned portion and add more if genuinely hungry.
- Avoid eating continuously while working at the computer; step away when possible.
- Use hunger/fullness cues instead of rigid restriction.
- Prefer whole fruit over juice.

Nutrition Note

Protein needs are approximate and may vary with activity level, health status, dietary requirements and individual goals. The 84–98 g/day target is based on approximately 1.2–1.4 g/kg/day for a 70 kg adult. This meal plan is general nutrition guidance and is not a substitute for individualized advice from a qualified dietitian or healthcare professional.

Quality check completed: each day includes 5+ vegetables, 3 whole-fruit servings/kinds, approximately 84–98 g protein, multiple protein opportunities, fibre-rich foods, balanced carbohydrate portions, varied legumes/grains/vegetables/fruits and workday-friendly preparation.